Year 1 Maths - Measure with Informal Units

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LEARN IT - look, say and notice

Model: A pencil is 7 linking cubes long when equal cubes touch end-to-end with no gaps or overlaps.

Remember: Use equal units, start at the edge and place units end-to-end.

A. TRY IT TOGETHER

1. Which is fair: mixed-size blocks or equal cubes?

2. A line uses 6 cubes with one gap. Is the measure reliable?

3. Draw 5 equal units end-to-end.

B. MY PRACTICE

1. A book is 9 paperclips long. Record the measure.

2. Fix a row with an overlap.

3. Explain why tiny units give a different count from large units.

4. Estimate a crayon in cubes, then describe how to check.

5. Which is longer: 8 cubes or 6 cubes, using the same cubes?

C. I CAN DO IT

Measure or plan to measure one object using a uniform informal unit.

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D. USE IT IN A REAL SITUATION

Two children measure one table: 12 large blocks and 20 small blocks. Explain why both results can be correct.

E. CHECK AND EXPLAIN

1. Why do gaps make the result too small?

2. What must stay the same when comparing two measured lengths?

MY LEARNING REVIEW

☐ I can do it. ☐ I need a little help. ☐ I need more practice.

I understood:

I found this difficult:

PARENT / CARER TIP

Measure a book with paperclips twice. Deliberately leave a gap once and discuss why the answers differ.

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COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

Guided	Equal cubes; no; five touching equal units.
Practice	9 paperclips; remove overlap; smaller units require more; measure end-to-end; 8 cubes.
Independent	Valid plan/result with named uniform unit.
Application	Different unit sizes create different counts; both can cover the same length.

TEACHER NOTES - what to notice

Success evidence: Measures length with uniform informal units used end-to-end.

Common difficulty: Counting marks instead of spaces/units or leaving gaps.

Next step: Repeat with a second unit and compare counts.

QUICK CONFERENCE RECORD

☐ Secure ☐ Developing ☐ Re-teach

Evidence / next lesson focus: